



## MSC World America — Family Edition

December 5 – 12, 2026 · Our family sailing

**Ship:** MSC World America · **Sailing from:** MSC Miami Cruise Terminal · **Cabins:** \_\_\_\_\_

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, MSC's quirks, and the family rhythm.

### Day by day

Times are from this sailing's own MSC for Me itinerary (retrieved 2026-08-20) — re-verify in the app close to sailing.

| # | Date       | Port                                        | Hours ashore                             | Dock/Tender                                 | The one thing                                                                                                        |
|---|------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Sat Dec 5  | <b>PortMiami</b><br>—<br><b>embarkation</b> | board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart 5:00 PM | —                                           | Register the kids at Doremiland on boarding. Sailaway at the World Promenade (Deck 8 aft).                           |
| 2 | Sun Dec 6  | Cruising at sea                             | —                                        | —                                           | Settling-in day. Possible Gala Evening; specialty dining slots open.                                                 |
| 3 | Mon Dec 7  | <b>Roatán, Honduras</b>                     | ~9:00 AM – 6:00 PM                       | dock at Coxen Hole (Port of Roatán)         | West Bay Beach + reef snorkel. <b>December = rainy-season tail (rain 3 days in 4) — loose plan, dry bags.</b>        |
| 4 | Tue Dec 8  | <b>Costa Maya, Mexico</b>                   | ~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM                       | dock                                        | Easiest family day: walk from ship to the free pool complex, or Chacchoben ruins (~\$50 indep).                      |
| 5 | Wed Dec 9  | <b>Cozumel, Mexico</b>                      | ~9:00 AM – 7:00 PM                       | dock (Punta Langosta, Intl, or Puerta Maya) | Chankanaab (~\$50) — calmest kid snorkel. Palancar for confident swimmers if no norther.                             |
| 6 | Thu Dec 10 | Cruising at sea                             | —                                        | —                                           | Recovery day. Second Gala likely. Laundry round; book any Ocean Cay cabana tonight.                                  |
| 7 | Fri Dec 11 | <b>Ocean Cay (Bahamas)</b>                  | 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM (late departure)       | dock alongside                              | Seakers Family Cove first. <b>8 PM departure = the lighthouse evening show is in play — check the daily program.</b> |
| 8 | Sat Dec 12 | <b>PortMiami</b><br>—<br><b>debarkation</b> | off by 10:00 AM                          | —                                           | Uber to MIA ~\$30–45. Home thirteen days before Christmas.                                                           |

**Possible Gala Evenings:** typically the two sea-day evenings (Day 2 + Day 6). Smart-casual otherwise; **MSC's dress culture is European-casual**. One nicer outfit per kid covers both.

**MSC for Me app** is the operational hub — daily program, dining bookings, kids-club hours, account balance, deck plans. **Download and log in for the whole family before sailing.**

**Currency aboard:** USD. **Service Charge (gratuity):** \$17/day standard (\$23 Yacht Club) as of May 11, 2026; **child rates differ — verify the current schedule with MSC or your agent.**

**December weather, in one line:** Miami mild and dry (78/65) · Roatán warm and often wet (81/77) · Mexican ports warm with shower odds (81–82/74) · Ocean Cay pleasant Bahamian winter (76/72) — normals from the 2020–2024 archive; the real forecast lands in the companion PWA ~16 days out. **Pack light layers and rain shells.**

**Decide before you board.** Run the [drink-calculator](#) on real drinking patterns, the [budget-calculator](#) for the family total, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for Service Charge + cash tips — MSC mid-sail upgrades cost more per day.

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## Getting to the ship — and getting home

### Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

**Friday, December 4 — fly in.** Same-day flights to an afternoon all-aboard are risky, and December adds front-driven delays across the eastern seaboard. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach.

**Saturday, December 5 — embarkation.**

- **Terminal: MSC Miami Cruise Terminal** at PortMiami — the MSC-built terminal opened April 2025. *Different from where Royal Caribbean and Carnival board.* Verify the address in the MSC for Me app.
- **MIA → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal garage ran **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026 — verify); offsite lots \$7–14/day with shuttle — weigh the shuttle against a family's bag pile.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM. Departure 5:00 PM (MSC app); be aboard with an hour's margin — more with kids.
- **Online check-in via MSC for Me** for every passenger — done at home beats a 20-minute queue with children.

### Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with the color-coded tag — or self-carry everything and walk off in the first wave (with kids, seriously consider it).
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at Il Mercato or La Brasserie.
- **~7:00 AM:** Arrival + customs clearance. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

**Carry-on on debark morning:** change of clothes per person, all medications, passports, chargers, valuables.

**PortMiami → MIA:** Uber/Lyft **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes**; pre-book against Saturday surge. Domestic flight after 4 PM → leave the port by 1:30 PM; MIA TSA runs 30–60 min in the Saturday return rush.

**Killing hours before an evening flight:** Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace (10-min walk) · Pérez Art Museum (\$20, air-conditioned) · Brickell by short Uber.

## Areas of interest during the cruise

### On the ship — World America spots worth knowing

- **The World Promenade** (Deck 8 aft) — seven-deck outdoor walkway around the Y-shaped stern. Signature space; December evenings up here want a light layer.
- **The World Galleria** (Decks 6–8 mid-ship) — three-deck LED-ceiling atrium. **The family meeting point:** “if we’re separated — Galleria, Deck 6, on the hour.”
- **Venom Drop @ The Spiral** — 11-deck dry slide; longest at sea. First hour after opening (typically 10 AM) has the shortest line.
- **Doremiland Kids Clubs / The Harbour** — included; register Day 1 when lines are shortest. Port days run longer morning sessions.
- **Cliffhanger @ The Harbour** — the only over-water swing at sea; four seats, ~160 ft above the water. Check the app for cost/height rules before promising a turn.
- **Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day intro rates; ~90 minutes is the right dose.
- **La Brasserie** (Deck 19) — 24/7 French-style casual; the calm breakfast.
- **Luna Park Pizza & Burger** (Deck 6) — the reliable kid-dinner fallback, included.

### Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise coffee at the World Promenade** — kids still asleep, wake unfolding below.
2. **Venom Drop first thing** — empty in the first hour.
3. **Kids-club morning session** — and the quiet hour it buys.
4. **Eataly at lunch** if dinner is booked out.
5. **Port talk for tomorrow’s destination** — the Roatán one especially (weather + logistics).

### Specialty dining picks

- **Eataly** (Deck 8) — first Eataly at sea; the one specialty venue that genuinely works for kids. **Book on Day 1.**
- **Kaito Teppanyaki** — the showy hibachi room; a family-dinner win.
- **Paxos** (Deck 8) — Greek seafood on the Promenade.
- **Butcher’s Cut** — steakhouse, for the grown-ups’ night.

### Port-day picks (one each)

- **Roatán** — West Bay Beach via taxi (\$6–10/person each way), reef 30 yds offshore. Backup: Gumbalimba Park (monkeys + zipline) if rain reshapes the day.
- **Costa Maya** — the pool complex inside the gated port, free with cruise cards; five minutes from re-boarding for nap runs.
- **Cozumel** — Chankanaab Beach Adventure Park (~\$50) for kid-calm snorkeling; Palancar (~\$50 indep) for confident swimmers on a calm day.
- **Ocean Cay** — **Seakers Family Cove** first (protected shallow zones); Beach Shack lunch 11–4; Marine Conservation Center free tour — the best half-hour of ocean stewardship the kids will get all week.

### The lighthouse show at Ocean Cay

Runs only on overnight or late-departure calls — and this sailing’s MSC-app window (8 AM – 8 PM) IS a late departure, with December darkness by ~5:30 PM. Whether it runs on your call is the ship’s program’s call — check aboard. If it runs, Lighthouse Bay is the seating area.

### Photo spots worth knowing

- **World Promenade Deck 8 aft sailaway** — wake beneath the Y-stern, downtown Miami fading in December’s early dusk.
- **The Galleria LED ceiling** — scene changes through the day.
- **Roatán West Bay Beach** — white sand, turquoise, reef offshore (rain-washed light can be the best of the week).
- **Ocean Cay striped lighthouse** at golden hour — Lighthouse Bay beach has the angle.
- **Gala night, everyone dressed** — the Photo Package earns its keep here.

*Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc in the voyage-packs folder. The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.*